



PARTNER GUIDE

Joining the IMWIRSA Global Maritime Welfare Network

A practical guide for seafarers' centres, missions and welfare organisations
considering partnership with IMWIRSA.



WHO WE ARE

About IMWIRSA

IMWIRSA — the International Maritime Welfare Innovation Research and Support Association — is an independent, non-profit international initiative headquartered in Tallinn, Estonia. We bring together researchers, seafarers' centres, maritime unions, port authorities and technology partners around a single goal: making seafarer welfare visible, evidence-based and accessible everywhere a ship calls.

We don't replace the seafarers' centres, missions and chaplaincies that have supported sailors for generations — we connect them. Every partner keeps its name, its funding and its independence; IMWIRSA provides the shared digital layer, research and coordination that lets the whole network work as one.

Research-led

Grounded in peer-reviewed evidence and real seafarer data.

Partnership-based

We grow through voluntary partnership, not replacement.

Technology-enabled

MWApp turns good intentions into something usable.

THE MODEL

Four Components of the Platform

1

Living Port Card

Structured, always-current information about the port: transport, seafarers' centre, shops, medical, safety — maintained by a local MWApp Port Coordinator.

2

MWApp Port Coordinator

A real person from your centre. New ports are registered through a structured questionnaire; afterwards the coordinator keeps the port card current through a simple Telegram bot, with every change checked by the IMWIRSA team before it goes live.

3

Volunteer Support Line

A live, anonymous chat available 24/7 for seafarers who need to talk to someone — from directions to a crisis.

4

Wellness Recovery Zone

A partnership with local specialists — massage, physiotherapy, counselling — offering a short, judgement-free window of relief near the centre.

WHAT CHANGES FOR YOUR ORGANISATION

What You Keep, What You Gain

Partnership with IMWIRSA is additive. Your centre's identity, governance and funding remain entirely your own.

YOU KEEP

- ✓ Full independence
- ✓ Your name, history and identity
- ✓ Your own management and funding
- ✓ Full organisational independence
- ✓ Freedom to work with other networks
- ✓ Right to leave the partnership any time

YOU GAIN

- ✓ A global network
- ✓ International visibility to seafarers in their own language
- ✓ More visitors through better accessibility
- ✓ Best-practice exchange across the network
- ✓ Free MWApp management tools and analytics
- ✓ Support to establish a Wellness Recovery Zone

Recognition for Your MWApp Port Coordinator

IMWIRSA offers a flexible recognition model that your organisation and your coordinator choose together:

- **Status & recognition** — official certificate, a named page on the platform, reference letter, private coordinator community access.
- **Financial support** — where budget allows, a monthly stipend (€50–150) and covered connectivity costs.
- **Organisational growth** — free promotion, access to grant programmes, staff training, priority feature access.

NO SURPRISES

Conditions of Joining the Pilot

NOT REQUIRED

- × No hidden costs
- × No mandatory financial contribution
- × No restructuring your organisation
- × No change to your charter or governance
- × No exclusivity — keep working with other networks
- × No new software or hardware to buy

WHAT'S NEEDED

- ✓ Just one committed person
- ✓ One MWhatsApp Port Coordinator from your centre
- ✓ About 45–60 minutes to complete the initial port questionnaire
- ✓ Telegram on the coordinator's phone, for ongoing updates afterwards
- ✓ A 30-minute introductory call, online
- ✓ Willingness to collaborate — fully voluntary participation

How Partnership Starts

- 1 Get in touch**
We reply within 24 hours.
- 2 Introductory call**
30–45 min online, within two weeks.
- 3 Centre profile & questionnaire**
Your centre is added to the international registry, and your coordinator completes the structured port questionnaire.
- 4 Pilot begins**
IMWIRSA reviews the questionnaire, platform access is granted, and your port goes live.

Ready to start the conversation?

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